Unai Fischer Abaigar

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Data Science Assistant Professor / Faculty Fellow, New York University

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Google Scholar

Academic Appointments

New York University — New York, NY
Data Science Assistant Professor / Faculty Fellow, Center for Data Science — Sep 2026–present

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — Cambridge, MA
Visiting Student, Laboratory for Information and Decision Systems — Apr–May 2026
Hosted by Sendhil Mullainathan and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Institute for Employment Research (IAB) — Nuremberg, Germany
Guest Researcher — Sep 2025–Jul 2026

Harvard University — Cambridge, MA
Fellow, Harvard SEAS and CRCS — Sep–Dec 2024
Hosted by Cynthia Dwork and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Hertie School Data Science Lab — Berlin, Germany
Research Associate — May–Jul 2022

Education

LMU Munich — Munich, Germany
Ph.D. (Dr. rer. nat.) in Statistics, magna cum laude — July 2026
Dissertation: *Foundations of Prediction in the Public Sphere*.
Advised by Frauke Kreuter and Christoph Kern, with Avi Feller and Julia Stoyanovich serving as examiners.
Affiliation: Munich Center for Machine Learning (MCML).

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg — Heidelberg, Germany
M.Sc. in Physics — 2022

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg — Heidelberg, Germany
B.Sc. in Physics — 2020

Honors and Awards

LMU-NYU Research Cooperation Program — 2025
- EUR 10,000 in project funding for *Foundations of Statistical Prediction in the Public Sphere*.

ICML Outstanding Paper Award — 2025
- One of six papers selected; awarded for *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off*.

Konrad Zuse School for Excellence in Reliable AI — 2023–2026
- Doctoral fellowship and advanced training program.

German Academic Scholarship Foundation (*Studienstiftung*) — 2016–2020
- Scholarship awarded to fewer than 0.5% of German students.

Publications

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Emily Aiken, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. "On the Meta-Design of Allocation Problems." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2026.
- Julian Rodemann, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, James Bailie, and Krikamol Muandet. "Performative Learning Theory." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026.

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. "The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2025. **Outstanding Paper Award**; highlight track at FORC 2025.
- Christoph Kern, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Jonas Schweisthal, Dennis Frauen, Rayid Ghani, Stefan Feuerriegel, Mihaela van der Schaar, and Frauke Kreuter. "Algorithms for Reliable Decision-Making Need Causal Reasoning." *Nature Computational Science*, 2025.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, Noam Barda, and Frauke Kreuter. "Bridging the Gap: Towards an Expanded Toolkit for AI-Driven Decision-Making in the Public Sector." *Government Information Quarterly* 41(4), 2024.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Frauke Kreuter. "The Missing Link: Allocation Performance in Causal Machine Learning." *ICML Workshop on Humans, Algorithmic Decision-Making and Society*, 2024.
- Christian Götzl, Selina Hiller, Christian Rauschenberg, Anita Schick, Janik Fechtelpeter, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Georgia Koppe, Daniel Durstewitz, Ulrich Reininghaus, and Silvia Krumm. "Artificial Intelligence-Informed Mobile Mental Health Apps for Young People: A Mixed-Methods Approach on Users' and Stakeholders' Perspectives." *Child and Adolescent Psychiatry and Mental Health* 16, 2022.

Talks

- *The Value of Prediction in Allocation* — Oct 2026
  CDS Seminar, New York University
- *Understanding the Value of Prediction in Allocation* — Mar 2026
  EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group, virtual
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — Jul 2025
  ICML, oral presentation, Vancouver
- *Adjusting Survey Estimates Using Multiaccuracy Postprocessing* — Jul 2025
  ITACOSM, Bologna
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — Jun 2025
  FORC, Stanford University
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — May 2025
  Social Foundations of Computation, Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems, Tübingen
- *Algorithmic Decision-Making in the Public Sector* — Oct 2024
  Theory of Computation Graduate Student Seminar, Harvard University
- *Introduction to Automated Decision-Making* — Oct 2024
  Coleridge Initiative, University of Maryland
- *Machine Learning for Reliable Decision-Making* — Apr 2024
  Zuse Industry Workshop on Algorithmic Decision-Making
- *Challenges for ML-Supported Decision-Making* — Jan 2024
  Department of Statistics Seminar, LMU Munich

Teaching

LMU Munich

Advanced Methods in Social Statistics and Social Data Science
Co-instructor — Summer 2024, 2025

Machine Learning Meets Causality
Co-instructor — Winter 2023

Computational Social Science
Teaching assistant — Winter 2022, 2023, 2025

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg

Machine Learning for Real-World Challenges
Teaching assistant — Summer 2022

Dynamical Systems Theory in Machine Learning and Data Science
Teaching assistant — Winter 2021

Professional Service and Outreach

NeurIPS Top Reviewer — 2026
Conference reviewer: ICML; NeurIPS
Member, EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group — 2026

Co-organizer, Data Science for Social Good Munich 2022–2024
Organizing team, DataFest Germany 2023, 2025